

Choosing a Job with Potential

Salary is a very important factor in choosing a job, but it's not always the most important one. Evaluate the total compensation package: salary, insurance, paid leave, stock options, retirement plan, and other benefits. Once you've placed a dollar value on the employer-provided benefits, evaluate other aspects of the job. Remember that there are some things you can't put a price tag on, such as training and experience. The best jobs will prepare you for the next step in your career by teaching you valuable skills and providing on-the-job training.

Evaluating a Potential Employer

When evaluating a potential employer, find out as much as you can about the industry. What's the history of growth in the industry and what's the anticipated future need for goods and services produced or provided by that industry? Is the industry trendy? Is it subject to government regulation? If so, what's the possible impact on the company?



There may be times when you need a job—any job—and you don't have the luxury of being selective, but you don't have to stay in one that's a dead end. Continue your search even after you find employment if the job doesn't provide you with what you need.

Also find out as much as you can about the company or organization. Detailed information, including current financial information, is easily available at your local library or online if the company trades publicly. Is the company financially stable? What are its size, reputation, and growth potential? In addition, if you know anybody who has worked for the